



Kinfield Navigator

Family Action Plan for Harold Fitzgerald- Montgomery

Prepared for Catherine Fitzgerald-Montgomery, granddaughter and enduring power of attorney

Date	22 September 2026
Plan version	Version 1.0
Plan reference	AP-HF8807

This plan contains personal information. Please share it only with people involved in Harry's care.

Your plan at a glance

KEY PRIORITIES

- Now** Make the home safer
- Now** Get the right help at home
- Now** Check the funding available
- Now** Get a needs assessment
- Now** Respond to memory changes

WHAT NEEDS ATTENTION

- Make the home safer
- Get the right help at home
- Check the funding available
- Get a needs assessment
- Respond to memory changes
- Plan a safe return home
- Arrange regular breaks for the carer
- Support Catherine as the main carer
- Put legal decision-making in place
- Prepare for a move into care

37 actions in this plan, 24 to start now.

RECOMMENDED NEXT STEP

Fit working smoke alarms (this week)

Your top priorities

- 1 Make the home safer** **Now**
Harry lives alone, so there may be no one nearby if something goes wrong.
- 2 Get the right help at home** **Now**
Harry currently has help from family (4 hours a week), meal delivery, home help (3 hours a week) and a day programme (6 hours a week).
- 3 Check the funding available** **Now**
Paying for care is a significant worry for the family.
- 4 Get a needs assessment** **Now**
A needs assessment has been requested but has not happened yet.

5 Respond to memory changes Now

Harry has a diagnosis of dementia.

What you told us

Harold Fitzgerald-Montgomery, 88, lives alone in a house in Whakatāne.

Harry needs help to move around and has had four falls in the past year.

Health conditions include vascular dementia, atrial fibrillation, chronic kidney disease stage 3, type 2 diabetes, osteoporosis, hearing loss and cataracts in both eyes.

The family has noticed significant memory and thinking changes, and there is a dementia diagnosis.

Harry is currently in hospital after a fall with a head injury and a urinary tract infection that caused sudden confusion.

Current support: help from family (4 hours a week), meal delivery, home help (3 hours a week) and a day programme (6 hours a week).

Catherine (granddaughter) is the main carer and describes the strain as high.

What matters most: stay near the beach he has lived beside for sixty years, keep his dog, Biscuit, for as long as possible, be close enough for Catherine to visit after work every day and avoid another emergency admission.

Notes from the family: Test string for wrapping: <https://example.com/a-very-long-link-without-any-spaces-that-must-wrap-inside-the-document-and-never-overflow-the-page-margins-at-all>

Recommended next steps

PRIORITY	ACTION	WHO	WHEN
Now			
Now	Fit working smoke alarms Install long-life photoelectric alarms in bedrooms, living areas and hallways, and test them.	Family	This week
Now	Arrange a personal alarm Ask the GP whether a funded personal alarm is available, or compare private monitored alarms.	Family with the GP	Within 2 weeks
Now	Agree a plan for when Harry goes missing Keep a recent photo and description ready, consider a location device, and tell close neighbours.	Family	This week

PRIORITY	ACTION	WHO	WHEN
Now	Walk through the home for hazards Check lighting, loose mats, clutter on floors, and how easy it is to get in and out of the shower and bed.	Family	Within a month
Now	List the daily tasks that need help Note what is hard each day (showering, meals, shopping, medicines) so support can be matched to real needs.	Catherine Fitzgerald-Montgomery	This week
Now	Ask the pharmacy about blister packs Pre-packed medicines by day and time reduce missed or doubled doses.	Family with the pharmacist	Within 2 weeks
Now	Check current entitlements Ask Work and Income which allowances apply, such as help with extra costs from a health condition.	Catherine Fitzgerald-Montgomery	Within a month
Now	Start the Residential Care Subsidy application Gather income and asset details for the application; it can be backdated only in limited cases.	Family or EPOA attorney	Within 2 weeks
Now	Confirm the assessment date Call the NASC service to check the referral arrived and ask for a date.	Catherine Fitzgerald-Montgomery	This week
Now	Prepare for the assessment Write down the hardest parts of each day, recent events and what the family can and cannot do.	Family	Before the assessment
Now	Contact a local dementia support service Ask about education sessions, day programmes and support for family carers.	Family	Within a month
Now	Set up memory supports at home A large clock and calendar, labelled cupboards and a regular daily routine reduce confusion.	Family	Within a month
Now	Ask for a discharge planning conversation Meet the ward team before discharge to agree support, equipment and follow-up.	Catherine Fitzgerald-Montgomery	Before discharge
Now	Confirm support is in place for the first two weeks Check who visits, when, and what happens if support does not arrive.	Family with the discharge planner	Before discharge
Now	Check medicines against the discharge letter Remove stopped medicines from the home and ask the pharmacist to review the new list.	Family with the pharmacist	First day home

PRIORITY	ACTION	WHO	WHEN
Now	Ask about the Carer Support Subsidy Raise it at the needs assessment or call the NASC service directly.	Catherine	Within 2 weeks
Now	Book a first short break Start with a few hours or a day programme so everyone gets used to it.	Family	Within a month
Now	Book a health check for Catherine Mention the caring role, sleep and stress so the GP can help.	Catherine	Within a month
Now	Share caring tasks across the family Agree who covers appointments, shopping, paperwork and regular visits.	Family	Within 2 weeks
Now	Set up both EPOAs with a lawyer Book a lawyer and choose attorneys for property and for personal care and welfare.	Harry with family	Within a month
Now	Find existing legal documents Check with the family lawyer or trustee company whether an EPOA or will already exists, and keep copies.	Catherine Fitzgerald-Montgomery	Within 2 weeks
Now	Confirm the level of care needed A needs assessment decides whether rest home, hospital or dementia level care is right.	Family with the GP	Within 2 weeks
Now	Visit care homes and check vacancies Visit at least two homes at different times of day, and ask about extra charges.	Family	Within a month
Now	Book a GP falls review Ask for a medication review and checks of eyesight, blood pressure and feet.	Catherine Fitzgerald-Montgomery	Within 2 weeks
Soon			
Soon	Start a strength and balance programme Find a local class or ask for a referral to an in-home programme.	Harry with family support	Within a month
Soon	Ask for an occupational therapy home assessment An occupational therapist can recommend rails, seating and changes that make moving around safer.	Family with the GP	Within a month
Soon	Write a simple money snapshot List income, savings, regular costs and the value of the home, so options can be compared.	Family or EPOA attorney	Within a month

PRIORITY	ACTION	WHO	WHEN
Soon	Get independent financial advice A free budgeting service or a financial adviser can explain the options.	Family	Within 2 months
Soon	Check eligibility for Total Mobility Ask the GP or a local agency about an assessment.	Family	Within a month
Soon	Ask the GP about driving safety Discuss whether a driving assessment is needed.	Catherine Fitzgerald-Montgomery	Within a month
Soon	Find one regular weekly activity A club, class, church group or day programme that Harry would enjoy.	Family	Within 2 months
Soon	Check hearing and eyesight Untreated hearing or vision loss often makes social contact harder.	Harry with family	Within 3 months
Soon	Fit bathroom rails and a shower seat The bathroom is the most common place for falls at home.	Family	Within a month
Soon	Add rails on both sides of stairs Make sure stairs are well lit, with rails that can be gripped firmly.	Family	Within a month
Soon	Make a one-page emergency sheet List medicines, conditions, allergies and contacts, and keep it on the fridge.	Family	Within 2 weeks
Soon	Agree a backup plan if the main carer is unwell Decide who steps in, and how respite could be arranged at short notice.	Family	Within a month
Plan ahead			
Plan ahead	Start an advance care plan Talk with Harry and the GP about what matters most, and write it down.	Harry with the GP	Within 3 months

Your action plan, by topic

Only the topics that apply to Harry are included.

Staying safely at home

Now

WHAT WE NOTICED

- Harry lives alone, so there may be no one nearby if something goes wrong.
- You mentioned: steep driveway, gas heater left on, loose carpet on the stairs, no rail in the shower, front door lock that jams and overgrown path to the letterbox.
- The home may not have working smoke alarms.
- Harry does not have a personal alarm to call for help.
- There have been times when Harry has left home and become lost or confused.

WHY THIS MATTERS

Small changes at home, such as working alarms, good lighting and a way to call for help, prevent many emergencies and make it more likely someone can keep living at home.

WHAT TO DO NEXT

- ☐ **Fit working smoke alarms** · This week · Family
Install long-life photoelectric alarms in bedrooms, living areas and hallways, and test them.
- ☐ **Arrange a personal alarm** · Within 2 weeks · Family with the GP
Ask the GP whether a funded personal alarm is available, or compare private monitored alarms.
- ☐ **Agree a plan for when Harry goes missing** · This week · Family
Keep a recent photo and description ready, consider a location device, and tell close neighbours.
- ☐ **Walk through the home for hazards** · Within a month · Family
Check lighting, loose mats, clutter on floors, and how easy it is to get in and out of the shower and bed.

WHO MAY BE ABLE TO HELP

Family and neighbours · GP or practice nurse · Occupational therapist · Fire and Emergency New Zealand

QUESTIONS WORTH ASKING

GP

- Would Harry qualify for a funded personal alarm, and how do we arrange it?

Occupational therapist

- Which changes in the home would make the biggest difference to safety?

USEFUL INFORMATION

Smoke alarms [16]

Fire and Emergency New Zealand recommends long-life photoelectric smoke alarms in every bedroom, living area and hallway, and offers home fire safety advice.

Home care and support

Now

WHAT WE NOTICED

- Harry currently has help from family (4 hours a week), meal delivery, home help (3 hours a week) and a day programme (6 hours a week).
- Harry needs help with moving around, which makes personal care and daily tasks harder.
- Taking medicines correctly has become difficult without help.

WHY THIS MATTERS

The right mix of help, from a few hours of household support to daily personal care, is often what makes staying at home possible and safe.

WHAT TO DO NEXT

- ☐ **List the daily tasks that need help** · This week · Catherine Fitzgerald-Montgomery
Note what is hard each day (showering, meals, shopping, medicines) so support can be matched to real needs.
- ☐ **Ask the pharmacy about blister packs** · Within 2 weeks · Family with the pharmacist
Pre-packed medicines by day and time reduce missed or doubled doses.

WHO MAY BE ABLE TO HELP

Needs Assessment and Service Coordination (NASC) · GP · Home support providers · Pharmacist

QUESTIONS WORTH ASKING

NASC

- What funded home support could Harry be eligible for, and how long is the wait?

Pharmacist

- Could medicines be supplied in blister packs, and can the pharmacy review them?

USEFUL INFORMATION

Funded support starts with an assessment [1]

Health New Zealand funds home support for eligible older people after a needs assessment by the local NASC service. A GP can make the referral.

OPTIONS THAT MAY SUIT

Shown because they match Harry's criteria, not as recommendations. Sample providers for testing.

Bayside Care at Home

Matches: Location: Bay of Plenty; Dementia support

Does not match: Availability: waiting list

Government funding

Now

WHAT WE NOTICED

- Paying for care is a significant worry for the family.
- The family is considering an application for the Residential Care Subsidy.

WHY THIS MATTERS

Several government subsidies depend on assessments and applications that take time. Starting early avoids paying costs that could have been covered.

WHAT TO DO NEXT

- ☐ **Check current entitlements** · Within a month · Catherine Fitzgerald-Montgomery
Ask Work and Income which allowances apply, such as help with extra costs from a health condition.
- ☐ **Start the Residential Care Subsidy application** · Within 2 weeks · Family or EPOA attorney
Gather income and asset details for the application; it can be backdated only in limited cases.

WHO MAY BE ABLE TO HELP

Work and Income · NASC · Budgeting services · Lawyer or financial adviser

QUESTIONS WORTH ASKING

Work and Income

- Which subsidies or allowances could Harry be eligible for now?

NASC

- Does Harry's assessed level of care allow a subsidy application?

USEFUL INFORMATION

Residential Care Subsidy [4]

Helps pay for long-term rest home or hospital care after a needs assessment. It is income and asset tested; as at 1 July 2026 the asset thresholds are \$300,811 (Threshold A) and \$164,731 (Threshold B), and they change each year.

Residential Care Loan [5]

If assets are over the threshold mainly because of a home, a Residential Care Loan from Work and Income may help cover care costs.

Needs assessment

Now

WHAT WE NOTICED

- A needs assessment has been requested but has not happened yet.

WHY THIS MATTERS

Most funded support for older people in New Zealand, including home support, carer relief and residential care subsidies, starts with a needs assessment by the local NASC service.

WHAT TO DO NEXT

- ☐ **Confirm the assessment date** · This week · Catherine Fitzgerald-Montgomery
Call the NASC service to check the referral arrived and ask for a date.
- ☐ **Prepare for the assessment** · Before the assessment · Family
Write down the hardest parts of each day, recent events and what the family can and cannot do.

WHO MAY BE ABLE TO HELP

GP · NASC service · Hospital social worker

QUESTIONS WORTH ASKING

GP

- Can you refer Harry for a needs assessment, and how urgent should we say it is?

NASC

- Can family be present at the assessment, and what should we bring?

USEFUL INFORMATION

How assessments work ^[1]

A NASC assessor visits to understand daily needs, health and support, then coordinates the services the person is eligible for.

Dementia and memory changes

Now

WHAT WE NOTICED

- Harry has a diagnosis of dementia.
- Harry has sometimes become lost or left home unexpectedly.

WHY THIS MATTERS

An early assessment opens the door to support, treatment of other causes, and planning while Harry can still take part in decisions.

WHAT TO DO NEXT

- ☐ **Contact a local dementia support service** · Within a month · Family
Ask about education sessions, day programmes and support for family carers.

- ☐ **Set up memory supports at home** · Within a month · Family

A large clock and calendar, labelled cupboards and a regular daily routine reduce confusion.

WHO MAY BE ABLE TO HELP

GP · Alzheimers New Zealand or Dementia New Zealand local services · Older persons' mental health team

QUESTIONS WORTH ASKING

GP

- Could these changes have another cause, such as medication, infection or low mood?
- Should Harry be referred to a memory service or specialist?

USEFUL INFORMATION

Local dementia support [12]

Alzheimers New Zealand and its member organisations offer information, education and support for people living with dementia and their families.

OPTIONS THAT MAY SUIT

Shown because they match Harry's criteria, not as recommendations. Sample providers for testing.

Memory Café Network (community)

Matches: Location: Bay of Plenty; Dementia support; Availability: vacancy or capacity now

Hospital discharge

Now

WHAT WE NOTICED

- Harry is in hospital after a fall with a head injury and a urinary tract infection that caused sudden confusion, with discharge expected on 2 October 2026.

WHY THIS MATTERS

The first weeks after hospital carry the highest risk of another admission. A clear plan for support, medicines and follow-up makes a safe return much more likely.

WHAT TO DO NEXT

- ☐ **Ask for a discharge planning conversation** · Before discharge · Catherine Fitzgerald-Montgomery
Meet the ward team before discharge to agree support, equipment and follow-up.
- ☐ **Confirm support is in place for the first two weeks** · Before discharge · Family with the discharge planner
Check who visits, when, and what happens if support does not arrive.
- ☐ **Check medicines against the discharge letter** · First day home · Family with the pharmacist
Remove stopped medicines from the home and ask the pharmacist to review the new list.

WHO MAY BE ABLE TO HELP

Ward discharge planner · Hospital social worker · GP · NASC

QUESTIONS WORTH ASKING

Hospital team

- What support will Harry need at home, and who will arrange it before discharge?
- Which medicines have changed, and why?
- What follow-up appointments are booked, and who do we call if things go wrong?

OPTIONS THAT MAY SUIT

Shown because they match Harry's criteria, not as recommendations. Sample providers for testing.

Bayside Care at Home

Matches: Location: Bay of Plenty; Dementia support

Does not match: Availability: waiting list

Respite

Now

WHAT WE NOTICED

- Catherine has not yet had a planned break from caring.

WHY THIS MATTERS

Regular breaks protect the carer's own health, and that is often what keeps care at home sustainable.

WHAT TO DO NEXT

- ☐ **Ask about the Carer Support Subsidy** · Within 2 weeks · Catherine
Raise it at the needs assessment or call the NASC service directly.
- ☐ **Book a first short break** · Within a month · Family
Start with a few hours or a day programme so everyone gets used to it.

WHO MAY BE ABLE TO HELP

NASC · Day programmes · Residential respite providers

QUESTIONS WORTH ASKING

NASC

- Is Catherine eligible for the Carer Support Subsidy, and how can it be used?

USEFUL INFORMATION

Carer Support Subsidy [2]

Reimburses part of the cost of a break for full-time unpaid carers. It is allocated through a NASC needs assessment and can pay for a relief carer, a day programme or short residential respite.

Planning breaks [3]

The Ministry of Social Development's guide for carers explains respite options and how to plan them.

OPTIONS THAT MAY SUIT

Shown because they match Harry's criteria, not as recommendations. Sample providers for testing.

Coastline Respite House

Matches: Location: Bay of Plenty; Dementia support; Budget: up to \$1,450 a week; Availability: vacancy or capacity now

Support for the family carer

Now

WHAT WE NOTICED

- Catherine (granddaughter) is the main carer.
- Catherine is under a lot of strain and may be close to exhaustion.

WHY THIS MATTERS

Family carers often put their own health last. If the main carer becomes unwell, the whole care arrangement can fall apart quickly.

WHAT TO DO NEXT

- ☐ **Book a health check for Catherine** · Within a month · Catherine
Mention the caring role, sleep and stress so the GP can help.
- ☐ **Share caring tasks across the family** · Within 2 weeks · Family
Agree who covers appointments, shopping, paperwork and regular visits.

WHO MAY BE ABLE TO HELP

Carer's own GP · Carers NZ · Wider family and friends

QUESTIONS WORTH ASKING

GP

- Can Catherine have a health check that takes the caring role into account?

USEFUL INFORMATION

Carers NZ [13]

Carers NZ provides information, advice and peer support for family carers.

WHAT WE NOTICED

- An Enduring Power of Attorney for property is not in place.
- An Enduring Power of Attorney for personal care and welfare is not in place.
- There is no advance care plan recording Harry's wishes.

WHY THIS MATTERS

An EPOA can only be made while a person can still understand it. Without one, the family may need to apply to the Family Court to make decisions, which takes time and money.

WHAT TO DO NEXT

- ☐ **Set up both EPOAs with a lawyer** · Within a month · Harry with family
Book a lawyer and choose attorneys for property and for personal care and welfare.
- ☐ **Find existing legal documents** · Within 2 weeks · Catherine Fitzgerald-Montgomery
Check with the family lawyer or trustee company whether an EPOA or will already exists, and keep copies.
- ☐ **Start an advance care plan** · Within 3 months · Harry with the GP
Talk with Harry and the GP about what matters most, and write it down.

WHO MAY BE ABLE TO HELP

Lawyer or trustee company · GP (for capacity questions) · Te Tari Kaumātua Office for Seniors

QUESTIONS WORTH ASKING

Lawyer

- What does Harry need to set up both EPOAs, and how long will it take?

GP

- Is Harry able to make and sign an EPOA now?

USEFUL INFORMATION

Two kinds of EPOA [8]

One covers property and money, the other covers personal care and welfare. A welfare EPOA only comes into effect if the person is assessed as no longer able to make decisions.

Making an EPOA [7]

Te Tari Kaumātua publishes the standard forms and explains how they must be witnessed.

Advance care planning [9]

An advance care plan records what matters most to a person about future care, so family and clinicians can follow their wishes.

OPTIONS THAT MAY SUIT

Shown because they match Harry's criteria, not as recommendations. Sample providers for testing.

Seniors' Legal Clinic (community law)

Matches: Location: Bay of Plenty; Availability: vacancy or capacity now

Residential care

Now

WHAT WE NOTICED

- The family is considering residential care as soon as possible.

WHY THIS MATTERS

Choosing a care home is easier with time to visit, compare and apply for funding, rather than deciding during a crisis.

WHAT TO DO NEXT

- ☐ **Confirm the level of care needed** · Within 2 weeks · Family with the GP
A needs assessment decides whether rest home, hospital or dementia level care is right.
- ☐ **Visit care homes and check vacancies** · Within a month · Family
Visit at least two homes at different times of day, and ask about extra charges.

WHO MAY BE ABLE TO HELP

NASC · Care home managers · Work and Income · Lawyer or EPOA attorney

QUESTIONS WORTH ASKING

Care home

- Do you have a vacancy at the assessed level, and what are the extra charges?
- How do you support new residents and families in the first weeks?

USEFUL INFORMATION

Levels of care [6]

Aged residential care in New Zealand is provided at rest home, hospital, dementia and psychogeriatric levels. The level is confirmed by a needs assessment.

OPTIONS THAT MAY SUIT

Shown because they match Harry's criteria, not as recommendations. Sample providers for testing.

Coastline Respite House

Matches: Location: Bay of Plenty; Dementia support; Budget: up to \$1,450 a week; Availability: vacancy or capacity now

WHAT WE NOTICED

- Harry has had four falls in the last 12 months.
- Harry is worried about falling, which can lead to moving less and becoming weaker.

WHY THIS MATTERS

One fall makes another more likely. Many falls can be prevented with a medication review, strength and balance exercise, and a safer home.

WHAT TO DO NEXT

- ☐ **Book a GP falls review** · Within 2 weeks · Catherine Fitzgerald-Montgomery
Ask for a medication review and checks of eyesight, blood pressure and feet.
- ☐ **Start a strength and balance programme** · Within a month · Harry with family support
Find a local class or ask for a referral to an in-home programme.
- ☐ **Ask for an occupational therapy home assessment** · Within a month · Family with the GP
An occupational therapist can recommend rails, seating and changes that make moving around safer.

WHO MAY BE ABLE TO HELP

GP · Physiotherapist · Occupational therapist · Live Stronger for Longer classes

QUESTIONS WORTH ASKING

GP

- Could any of Harry's medicines be adding to dizziness or falls?
- Should eyesight, blood pressure or bone health be checked after these falls?

Physiotherapist

- Which strength and balance programme suits Harry now?

USEFUL INFORMATION

Strength and balance ^[10]

Live Stronger for Longer lists community strength and balance classes around New Zealand, and GPs can refer people to an in-home programme.

Financial considerations

WHAT WE NOTICED

- The family has a guide budget of about \$1,450 a week for care or accommodation.
- Harry owns their home, which affects subsidies and how a move could be funded.

WHY THIS MATTERS

Retirement villages and residential care have very different costs and contracts. Understanding them early avoids rushed decisions.

WHAT TO DO NEXT

- ☐ **Write a simple money snapshot** · Within a month · Family or EPOA attorney
List income, savings, regular costs and the value of the home, so options can be compared.
- ☐ **Get independent financial advice** · Within 2 months · Family
A free budgeting service or a financial adviser can explain the options.

WHO MAY BE ABLE TO HELP

Financial adviser · Lawyer · Free budgeting services

QUESTIONS WORTH ASKING

Financial adviser

- How would each option affect Harry's income and assets over five years?

Transport

Soon

WHAT WE NOTICED

- Getting to appointments and shops has become difficult.
- Harry still drives, although there are concerns about memory.

WHY THIS MATTERS

Losing transport often leads to missed appointments and isolation. Subsidised options can keep someone independent.

WHAT TO DO NEXT

- ☐ **Check eligibility for Total Mobility** · Within a month · Family
Ask the GP or a local agency about an assessment.
- ☐ **Ask the GP about driving safety** · Within a month · Catherine Fitzgerald-Montgomery
Discuss whether a driving assessment is needed.

WHO MAY BE ABLE TO HELP

Total Mobility agencies · Community transport services · GP (for driving fitness)

QUESTIONS WORTH ASKING

GP

- Is Harry still safe to drive, and should a driving assessment be done?

USEFUL INFORMATION

Total Mobility ^[11]

Subsidised taxi and ride-share fares for people who cannot use public transport safely because of an impairment. Eligibility is assessed by an approved agency and subsidies vary by region.

Social connection

Soon

WHAT WE NOTICED

- Harry is often alone and has little contact with others.

WHY THIS MATTERS

Loneliness affects mood, memory and physical health. One regular activity each week makes a real difference.

WHAT TO DO NEXT

- ☐ **Find one regular weekly activity** · Within 2 months · Family
A club, class, church group or day programme that Harry would enjoy.
- ☐ **Check hearing and eyesight** · Within 3 months · Harry with family
Untreated hearing or vision loss often makes social contact harder.

WHO MAY BE ABLE TO HELP

Age Concern · Local community groups · Church or cultural groups

USEFUL INFORMATION

Visiting services ^[14]

Age Concern runs visiting and social programmes for older people in many parts of New Zealand.

OPTIONS THAT MAY SUIT

Shown because they match Harry's criteria, not as recommendations. Sample providers for testing.

Memory Café Network (community)

Matches: Location: Bay of Plenty; Dementia support; Availability: vacancy or capacity now

Equipment and home changes

Soon

WHAT WE NOTICED

- The home has stairs Harry needs to use.
- Moving around the home safely needs some support.

WHY THIS MATTERS

Rails, shower seats and the right mobility aids are low-cost changes that prevent falls and keep people independent for longer.

WHAT TO DO NEXT

- ☐ **Fit bathroom rails and a shower seat** · Within a month · Family
The bathroom is the most common place for falls at home.
- ☐ **Add rails on both sides of stairs** · Within a month · Family
Make sure stairs are well lit, with rails that can be gripped firmly.

WHO MAY BE ABLE TO HELP

Occupational therapist · Equipment suppliers · Builder for rails and ramps

QUESTIONS WORTH ASKING

Occupational therapist

- Which equipment is funded, and which would we need to buy?

Emergency planning

Soon

WHAT WE NOTICED

- If Catherine became unwell suddenly, there is no backup plan for Harry's care.
- In an emergency, responders may not know Harry's medicines or who to contact.

WHY THIS MATTERS

A one-page emergency sheet and a backup carer plan save precious time when something unexpected happens.

WHAT TO DO NEXT

- ☐ **Make a one-page emergency sheet** · Within 2 weeks · Family
List medicines, conditions, allergies and contacts, and keep it on the fridge.
- ☐ **Agree a backup plan if the main carer is unwell** · Within a month · Family
Decide who steps in, and how respite could be arranged at short notice.

WHO MAY BE ABLE TO HELP

Family · GP · Pharmacist

USEFUL INFORMATION

Emergency kits ^[15]

Get Ready explains how to prepare a household emergency plan, including medicines and mobility needs.

Action checklist

Tick actions off as they are done. Your navigator can update the plan with your progress.

Now

- ☐ Fit working smoke alarms · This week
- ☐ Arrange a personal alarm · Within 2 weeks
- ☐ Agree a plan for when Harry goes missing · This week
- ☐ Walk through the home for hazards · Within a month
- ☐ List the daily tasks that need help · This week
- ☐ Ask the pharmacy about blister packs · Within 2 weeks
- ☐ Check current entitlements · Within a month
- ☐ Start the Residential Care Subsidy application · Within 2 weeks
- ☐ Confirm the assessment date · This week
- ☐ Prepare for the assessment · Before the assessment
- ☐ Contact a local dementia support service · Within a month
- ☐ Set up memory supports at home · Within a month
- ☐ Ask for a discharge planning conversation · Before discharge
- ☐ Confirm support is in place for the first two weeks · Before discharge
- ☐ Check medicines against the discharge letter · First day home
- ☐ Ask about the Carer Support Subsidy · Within 2 weeks
- ☐ Book a first short break · Within a month
- ☐ Book a health check for Catherine · Within a month
- ☐ Share caring tasks across the family · Within 2 weeks
- ☐ Set up both EPOAs with a lawyer · Within a month
- ☐ Find existing legal documents · Within 2 weeks
- ☐ Confirm the level of care needed · Within 2 weeks
- ☐ Visit care homes and check vacancies · Within a month
- ☐ Book a GP falls review · Within 2 weeks

Soon

- ☐ Start a strength and balance programme · Within a month
- ☐ Ask for an occupational therapy home assessment · Within a month
- ☐ Write a simple money snapshot · Within a month
- ☐ Get independent financial advice · Within 2 months

- ☐ Check eligibility for Total Mobility · Within a month
- ☐ Ask the GP about driving safety · Within a month
- ☐ Find one regular weekly activity · Within 2 months
- ☐ Check hearing and eyesight · Within 3 months
- ☐ Fit bathroom rails and a shower seat · Within a month
- ☐ Add rails on both sides of stairs · Within a month
- ☐ Make a one-page emergency sheet · Within 2 weeks
- ☐ Agree a backup plan if the main carer is unwell · Within a month

Plan ahead

- ☐ Start an advance care plan · Within 3 months

We can help you carry this out

Kinfield Navigator can help your family work through this plan: making calls, preparing for assessments and appointments, comparing options and updating the plan as things change.

Phone 0123456789 · **Email** plans@kinfield.example

Sources and important information

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2. Carer Support Subsidy, Health New Zealand | Te Whatu Ora. <https://www.healthnz.govt.nz/hospitals-services/eligibility-subsidies/carers-support-subsidy> (reviewed 22 September 2026)
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This plan gives general information based on what your family told us. It is not medical, legal or financial advice. Eligibility for funding and services is decided by the agencies involved, and details such as thresholds change over time. Please check with the relevant professional before making decisions.